

Availability of Sarawak DUN Hansard (as of December 2025)

Sarawak Dewan Undangan Negeri (DUN) Hansard (official transcripts of assembly proceedings) is **not readily available** to the public in a comprehensive, user-friendly format. Unlike federal Malaysian Parliament Hansard (fully searchable online since 1959), Sarawak's system is limited, time-bound, and requires effort to access. Below is a breakdown based on official sources and practices.

Key Limitations

- **Time-Restricted Access:** Unedited Hansard PDFs are posted on the official DUN website (duns.sarawak.gov.my) **only for 1 month after the sitting date**. After that, they are removed from public view. No explanation is given for this policy, but it contributes to the opacity.
- **No Public Archive or Search Portal:** There is no free, open online archive for historical or edited Hansard. An "e-Hansard" system exists (ehansard.sarawak.gov.my), but it requires a **username and password** (likely for members, staff, or registered users only). General public searches aren't supported without login.
- **No Proactive Digitization:** Older sessions (pre-2010s) are often inaccessible online; they may exist in physical form at the DUN library in Kuching but aren't digitized for remote access.

How to Access (Limited Options)

Method	Details	Ease of Access	Requirements
Official Website (Unedited)	Download PDFs from duns.sarawak.gov.my under "Hansard" section (e.g., recent 2025 sittings like November).	Moderate (if within 1 month)	Free; no login, but files auto-expire. Contact Publication Unit at 082-445434 for queries.
e-Hansard Portal	ehansard.sarawak.gov.my for basic/advanced searches and browsing.	Low	Login credentials (not public; apply

Method	Details	Ease of Access	Requirements
			via DUN office?).
Physical/In-Person	Visit DUN Building (Petra Jaya, Kuching) or State Library; request from archives.	Low	Travel to Kuching; possible fees for copies.
Freedom of Information (FOI)	File under Official Secrets Act exemptions via DUN Clerk or State Secretary's Office.	Very Low	Formal application; low success rate for full transcripts (e.g., recent rejections in 2025 sessions).
Media/Secondary Sources	Excerpts in newspapers (e.g., Sarawak Tribune, DayakDaily) or blogs (e.g., sarawakdunmay2012.blogspot.com for archived 2012 unedited PDFs).	Moderate	Free online, but incomplete/inaccurate.
Academic/Legal Databases	Partial access via paid services like CLJ Law or university libraries (e.g., Universiti Malaysia Sarawak).	Low	Subscription or institutional access.

Recent Examples (2025)

- **May 2025 Sitting:** Parts of unpublished Hansard were referenced in media (e.g., expunged remarks by Pending ADUN Violet Yong), but full text isn't public.
- **November 2025:** Unedited PDFs available until ~December 2025; after that, gone unless requested.

Why So Opaque?

This aligns with broader criticisms of Sarawak's transparency (e.g., opposition calls for open-data reforms in 2025 DUN sessions). Civil groups like ROSE advocate for full online archiving, similar to federal standards, but no changes as of now. If you're seeking a specific sitting (e.g., on allowances), emailing the Publication Unit or filing an FOI is your best bet—success varies.